

Freshman Year

SEPTEMBER

SEPTEMBER

Try something new

Welcome to high school! Now is a great time to sign up for activities outside the classroom. Clubs and teams are a great way to explore your interests and make new friends.

OCTOBER

OCTOBER

Start strong

How are classes going? Check in with your teachers to see how you're doing. Your freshman year is a great time to start building study habits.

NOVEMBER

DECEMBER

JANUARY

JANUARY

Make a plan

Reach out to your school counselor and let them know you want to go to college. Work with them to map out a four-year plan for the classes you'll need to take.

FEBRUARY

FEBRUARY

Connect with mentors

Think about people you trust who might be able to answer questions, provide advice, and keep you accountable.

MARCH

APRIL

APRIL

Make summer count

Research and apply for jobs, summer programs and internships. Use your summer to explore your interests.

MAY

SUMMER

Sophomore Year

SEPTEMBER

SEPTEMBER

Sign up for the PSAT

Talk to your counselor to make sure you're registered for the PSAT. Taking this test is great practice for college admissions tests—and if you do well, you can earn scholarships.

OCTOBER

OCTOBER

Assess your performance

How are classes going? If you're having a hard time in class, make sure to reach out to an adult or friend to find ways to improve.

NOVEMBER

DECEMBER

DECEMBER

Explore leadership opportunities

If you're involved in extracurricular activities, sophomore year is a great time to get more involved and volunteer for a leadership position.

JANUARY

JANUARY

Visit a college campus

tk

FEBRUARY

MARCH

MARCH

Plan your junior year

Meet with your school counselor to discuss your academic progress and pick classes for next year. Ask about honors, AP, or IB courses.

APRIL

APRIL

Make summer count

Research and apply for jobs, summer programs and internships. Use your summer to explore your interests.

MAY

MAY

Plan for admissions tests

The October ACT is five months away! Use the results from your PSAT to set your target score and identify areas where you need to focus.

SUMMER



Junior Year

SEPTEMBER

SEPTEMBER

Sign up for the ACT

OCTOBER

OCTOBER

Attend college fairs

Talk to a school counselor or mentor to find Fall college fairs. [tktk](#)

OCTOBER

Take the ACT

NOVEMBER

NOVEMBER

Make a college list

Start to make a list of colleges you might be interested in. One of the best places to start your search is at the **College Board's Big Future** website. [DIRECT TO GUIDE](#)

DECEMBER

JANUARY

Learn about financial aid

Talk to your family, mentor, or school counselor about your financial situation and learn more, using tools like financial aid need estimator tools on **CollegeBoard.org**.

JANUARY

JANUARY

Sign up for the SAT

FEBRUARY

MARCH

Visit colleges

Try to visit colleges during Spring Break. Campus visits are free—just visit the college website to arrange a tour. If you can't visit, find a virtual college fair at **College Week Live**.

MARCH

Take the SAT

MARCH

Register for the TOEFL

English Language Learners: find out if the colleges on your list require the TOEFL. Register to take the test.

MARCH

APRIL

MARCH

Sign up for the SAT

APRIL

Plan for Summer

Research and apply for jobs, summer programs and internships. Use your summer to explore your interests.

MAY

Take the SAT

MAY

Take AP Tests

JULY

Plan your senior year

Meet with your school counselor to discuss your academic progress and pick classes for next year. Ask about honors, AP, or IB courses.

JUNE

MAY

Ask for recommendations

Tell teachers and/or mentors that you will ask for letters of recommendation in the fall. Teachers appreciate early notice so they can start writing during summer break.

JULY

MAY

Find scholarships

Identify at least two scholarships that match your interests or talents.

JULY

Start your personal essay

You will need to write a personal essay for your college application. Reach out to a mentor to think about what you want to write and few outlines.

AUGUST

AUGUST 1

College application opens

JULY

Create a resume

Create a resume that includes all of your jobs and extracurricular activities.



Senior Year

